



John Walsh
Chief Operating Officer

1989
Founded

799K
Employees (Q3 FY26)

\$69.7B
FY2025 revenue

\$2.7B
FY2025 AI revenue

\$5.9B
FY2025 AI bookings

01 Who You're Meeting

John Walsh — Chief Operating Officer, Accenture.
In role: COO since 1 September 2023
Today: Runs Accenture's global business operations and infrastructure, and executes the enterprise reinvention strategy internally.
A career Accenture operator with more than thirty years at the firm. He built a technology-enabled global sales organisation as Chief Strategic Accounts & Global Sales Officer before becoming COO, and previously led the Communications, Media & Technology group and the Northern California office.
Career: Chief Operating Officer, Accenture; Chief Strategic Accounts & Global Sales Officer, Accenture; Group Chief Executive, Global Communications, Media & Technology, Accenture; Managing Director, Northern California, Accenture
Education: B.S., Iowa State University; Executive management programme, IMD (Switzerland)
The company: The scale player in technology services: ~799,000 people, \$69.7B of FY2025 revenue, and \$80.6B of new bookings. It has partnered with 195 of its top 200 clients for ten years or more, which makes it the default incumbent inside most large enterprises rather than a challenger.
What they sell: Strategy & Consulting, Technology, Operations and Song, delivered through industry groups and a large offshore delivery network. Its AI delivery runs on internal platforms such as GenWizard, and it reports generative and agentic AI as a separate revenue line.

02 Where The Company Sits

Accenture and Deloitte are now effectively tied at the top — Deloitte reported \$70.5B for the year ended 31 May 2025 against Accenture's \$69.67B for the year ended 31 August 2025, though the fiscal years do not line up. Accenture's differentiator is not strategy advice but delivery capacity at scale, and it is the one firm in this set that discloses AI as a reported revenue line. For a PE owner the relevant question is whether you are buying scarce expertise or rented capacity — Accenture is unambiguously the latter, and priced accordingly.

03 Talking Points

- The operations seat — relevant for delivery model, staffing seniority and how an engagement is actually resourced.
 - Sales organisation is his heritage, so commercial structure and account coverage are within his gift.
- What to pressure-test about the company:**
- Growth has slowed materially: FY2026 guidance of 2–5% local currency against 7% delivered in FY2025
 - A six-month business optimisation programme took a \$615M charge in Q4 FY2025, including \$344M of severance
 - Federal business (AFS) is a drag on FY2026 growth, worth about 1.5 points

04 GIP Context

GIP: No publicly disclosed GIP relationship. Accenture works across every infrastructure sector GIP invests in, so any engagement is most likely to arrive through a PortCo's existing master services agreement rather than at fund level. Validate internally before assuming a clean slate.
BlackRock: No publicly disclosed operating relationship. BlackRock funds hold ACN as a standard index position — a capital-markets fact, not evidence of a commercial relationship.
Others at Accenture: Julie Sweet (Chair & Chief Executive Officer); Karthik Narain (Group Chief Executive, Technology & Chief Technology Officer)